

DOCUMENT 00 · FRAMEWORK OVERVIEW

What SEVEN-G is and how it helps companies

A framework for value, governance and transformation with artificial intelligence

Fernando García · SEACHAD Version 0.1 (working draft) 16-09-2026 Living project

9

spheres of impact

3

ambition levels

0–7

phases with
decision gates

10

value measurement
rules

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01

What SEVEN-G means

SEVEN-G means **Seven-phase Enterprise Value & Governance**: one enabling phase 0 and seven value phases (1-7), with governance applied across all of them.

The intent of the framework is to enable, with AI support, a model of **enterprise self-consulting**: any company should be able to use SEVEN-G to implement, govern, measure, adapt, extend and improve its own AI system without depending on a closed third-party interpretation.

SEVEN-G is designed to be **compatible** with existing governance structures, with in-house or external consulting support, and with other frameworks the company may already use. It does not require replacing them: it allows organisations to integrate them, structure their contributions and convert them into traceable decisions based on shared value, risk, compliance and measurement criteria.

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SEVEN-G enables an organisation to **implement, govern and measure** artificial intelligence with the same rigour it applies to its finances, its risks or its regulatory compliance, and enables its decision and governance bodies to answer, with evidence, a question that almost no one can answer today:

Is the company transforming itself with AI, or is it just becoming more efficient?

Both are legitimate. The problem arises when they are confused: when a portfolio of automations is presented as transformation, when savings are declared that never materialise, or when the bets that could change the business are blocked using the same return criteria as a cost-cutting project.

The practical goal is for boards, senior management and control bodies to understand and measure the contribution of enterprise intelligence in their company, understand and contain its risks, and

decide with portfolio discipline which initiatives deserve investment to improve efficiency, transform capabilities and create measurable impact on P&L.

SEVEN-G provides four things:

- 1. **A map of where and with what ambition** to use AI: nine spheres of impact and three ambition levels (Optimise, Augment, Transform).
- 2. **A controlled lifecycle** for each initiative, with phases, auditable decision gates (*gates*) and a real ability to stop or retire.
- 3. **A governance system** with separate roles, clear responsibilities and mapped regulatory compliance (EU AI Act, ISO/IEC 42001, GDPR, DORA and sector-specific regulation).
- 4. **A measurement system** with explicit rules that separate validated value from declared value, efficiency from growth, and evidenced transformation from announced transformation.

Adoption can be **full or modular**: a company may deploy the entire framework or start with a specific component (for example measurement, *gates*, regulatory inventory or oversight dashboard) and then expand without losing methodological coherence.

All of this comes with templates, audit criteria and tools —including an AI dashboard for the board— that allow it to be applied in any sector.

02

The problem it solves

In most organisations, AI grows faster than their capacity to govern it. The symptoms are recognisable in any sector:

Symptom	Consequence
The board receives AI as an inventory of technical projects , not as business decisions.	It cannot prioritise, cannot make demands and cannot exercise its oversight responsibility.
There are many pilots and few use cases in production . Pilots are neither closed nor scaled.	Recurring cost with no return and a loss of internal credibility.
Value is declared, not validated. Released hours are added up as savings even though no one has realised them.	Aggregate figures that do not withstand an audit and poorly grounded investment decisions.
No one can stop a project. There are no formal criteria for iterating, pivoting or retiring.	Portfolios that only grow and concentrate risk.
Accountability is fragmented across technology, business, risk and compliance. Whoever builds also approves.	Weak controls and a lack of accountability.

Symptom	Consequence
Regulatory and security risk is addressed late: classification under the AI Act, impact assessments, suppliers, agents with excessive permissions, AI used by attackers.	Legal, reputational and operational exposure.
The word " transformation " is used to describe initiatives that do the same thing at lower cost.	The organisation believes it is transforming when it is only becoming more efficient, and fails to take the decisions that real transformation would require.

SEVEN-G starts from a premise: **these problems are not technological; they are problems of governance and measurement**. That is why the framework is aimed both at the teams that build and at those who decide and oversee.

03

What SEVEN-G helps with

3.1 Implementing AI

- Identify opportunities from the business, not from the technology available.
- Formulate each initiative as a **falsifiable value hypothesis**: baseline, target, attribution method and success threshold defined before investing.
- Follow a lifecycle with known phases and deliverables, from defining the context through to operation, scaling or retirement.
- Decide with explicit criteria at each *gate*: proceed, proceed with conditions, iterate, pivot or stop.
- Move from pilot to production with requirements for operation, human oversight, monitoring and reversibility.
- Address generative AI and agents with specific controls: evaluations, agent identity and permissions, intent-based access control, a kill switch and human validation for sensitive actions.

3.2 Governing AI

- Establish **who decides, who builds and who controls**, with segregation of duties: whoever builds does not audit, and no one approves their own work.
- Maintain an **AI system inventory** with each system's regulatory classification, its assessments (data protection, fundamental rights, security) and its owner.
- Integrate AI into existing bodies —board, risk committee, internal audit, compliance— instead of creating a parallel governance structure.

- Translate regulation into concrete controls. SEVEN-G does not embed any specific regulation: it **maps** each obligation to a phase, a role and a piece of evidence, so that the framework survives regulatory change.
- Manage AI suppliers: build, buy or partner; technological dependency; contracts that protect data and intellectual property; obligations relating to critical third parties.
- Treat deviations as **nonconformities**, with containment, root cause, corrective action and re-audit.

3.3 Measuring implementation and value

- Measure each use case in money, with a formula and a validation status: **validated** (by management control or audit), **declared** (by the business area) or **estimated** (by the AI Committee, the board or the assessment team).
- Separate **efficiencies** (lower cost) from **return** (revenue, retention, price, margin), and both from **recurring cost**.
- Apply rules that prevent inflated figures (section 6).
- Measure the **agility** of the decision-making system: time from idea to approval and to production, by risk level and ambition level.
- Measure **maturity** with observable evidence, not self-assessments.
- Keep a **register of recommendations and decisions** with persistent identifiers, owners, dates and evidence, so that follow-up does not depend on people's memory of meetings.

3.4 Knowing whether the company is transforming or just becoming more efficient

This is the framework's most distinctive contribution and is developed in section 5.

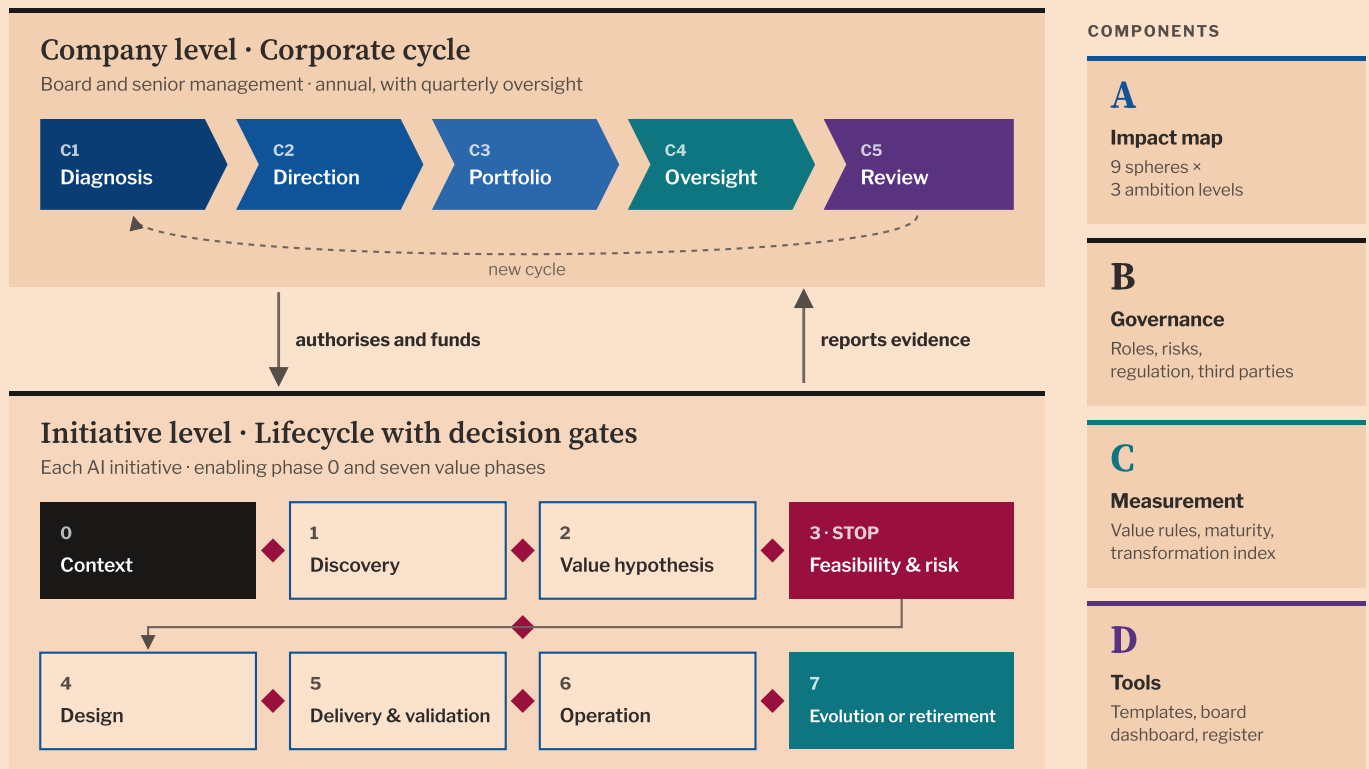
04

How the framework is built

SEVEN-G is organised into two levels of governance —the **company** level and the level of each **initiative**— and four components used at both levels.

SEVEN-G architecture

Two connected levels of governance and four cross-cutting components



The diamonds represent the decision gates (*gates*). Source: SEVEN-G · SEACHAD

4.1 Component A · Impact map: nine spheres and three ambition levels

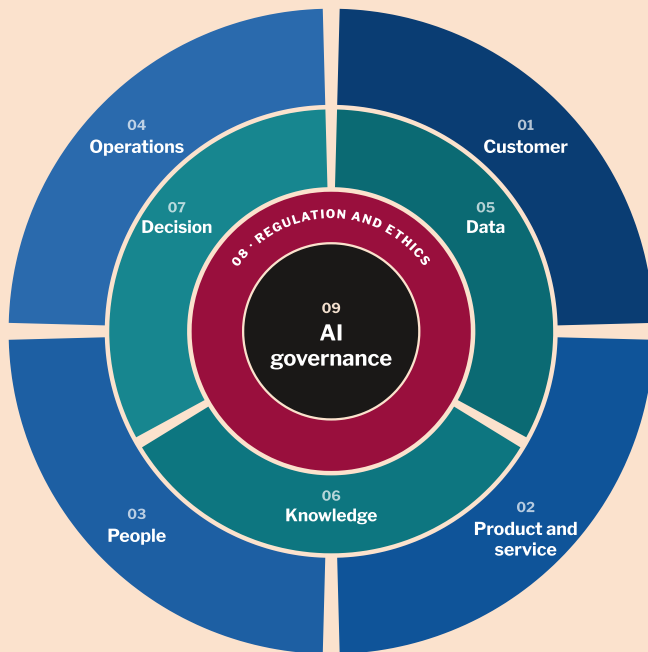
A board does not decide on use cases; it decides on risk, opportunity, competitive advantage and accountability. The impact map makes it possible to talk about AI **without talking about technology**.

Why it matters. Without an impact map, the portfolio fills up with technically attractive but strategically unstructured initiatives. The map forces explicit choices on where value should be created, what ambition is acceptable and what should not be funded.

Nine spheres, valid for any sector:

Impact map: nine spheres

From the outside in: where value is created, what enables it, the boundaries and the governance that connects it all



Where value is created

01 Customer · 02 Product and service · 03 People · 04 Operations

Enablers

05 Data · 06 Knowledge · 07 Decision.
This is where the uncomfortable questions arise.

Boundaries

08 Regulation, ethics and accountability.
Assessed in terms of compliance, anticipation and ethical leadership.

Meta-sphere

09 AI governance. Connects the other eight with the formality of finance, risk or compliance.

Source: SEVEN-G · SEACHAD

Type	Sphere	Reference question for the board
Where value is created	01 · Customer	If a competitor knows our customers better because it uses AI better, how long will it take us to lose relevance?
	02 · Product and service	Are we using AI to protect the current product or to build the next one?
	03 · People	Does AI replace, augment or reorganise people's work?
	04 · Operations	Which processes have a demonstrable short-term return and which require a complete redesign?
Enablers	05 · Data	Do we know what data we have, who is accountable for its quality and whether we can legally use it for AI?
	06 · Knowledge	How much critical knowledge depends on a few people and is not available to the organisation?

Type	Sphere	Reference question for the board
	07 · Decision	What does AI decide on its own, what requires human validation and what is never delegated?
Boundaries	08 · Regulation, ethics and accountability	Do we govern proactively, or do we wait for the regulator to force us?
Meta-sphere	09 · AI governance	Does AI have corporate governance with the same formality as finance, risk or compliance?

Three ambition levels, which are not a ladder but three types of bet with different cost, risk, timeframe and organisational resistance:

Level	What it means	Where the value lies	Who should decide
Optimise	Doing the same thing faster, cheaper or with fewer errors. It does not change what is done or who does it.	Mainly in efficiencies (avoided cost).	Management of the business area, within the portfolio framework.
Augment	People do what they could not do before. The role changes, not the business.	Combined: cost and performance (productivity, quality, conversion).	Senior management, with visibility for the AI Committee.
Transform	Changes what is offered, how the company competes or how it is organised.	Mainly in return (revenue, new services, competitive position) and in changes to the operating model.	Explicit decision by the board or senior management.

Spheres 08 and 09 are not assessed on these three levels, because they do not generate value in themselves: sphere 08 is assessed on *Compliance, Anticipation and Ethical leadership*, and sphere 09 on *Structure, Balance between speed and control and Supplier ecosystem* (grades Absent, Basic, Systematic and Advanced; document 10).

4.2 Company level · Corporate cycle

This is the cycle in which the board and senior management perform their role. It runs annually, with quarterly oversight:

Why it matters. Without a corporate cycle, AI decisions remain isolated projects. This cycle turns AI into a management discipline: it sets direction, allocates capital, oversees execution and requires annual evidence-based review.

Stage	Question it answers	Main output
C1 · Diagnosis	Where are we?	Maturity by dimension with evidence, current sphere map, efficiency–transformation profile, AI system inventory.
C2 · Direction	Where do we want to play, and with what ambition and risk appetite?	The company's AI thesis, ambition level per sphere, risk appetite, principles and corporate policy.
C3 · Portfolio	Which initiatives do we fund, which do we stop, and in what balance?	Prioritised portfolio with a balance across ambition levels, budget and owners.
C4 · Oversight	Is what was decided being delivered?	Board dashboard, register of recommendations, relevant <i>gate</i> decisions, incidents and nonconformities.
C5 · Review	Have we made progress? Are we transforming?	Annual review of maturity, the transformation index and the AI thesis.

A first implementation can concentrate C1 to C3 into **ninety days**: maturity diagnosis (month 1), map of risks and opportunities with owners and economic impact (month 2), and a governance structure with *gates*, metrics and reporting cadence (month 3).

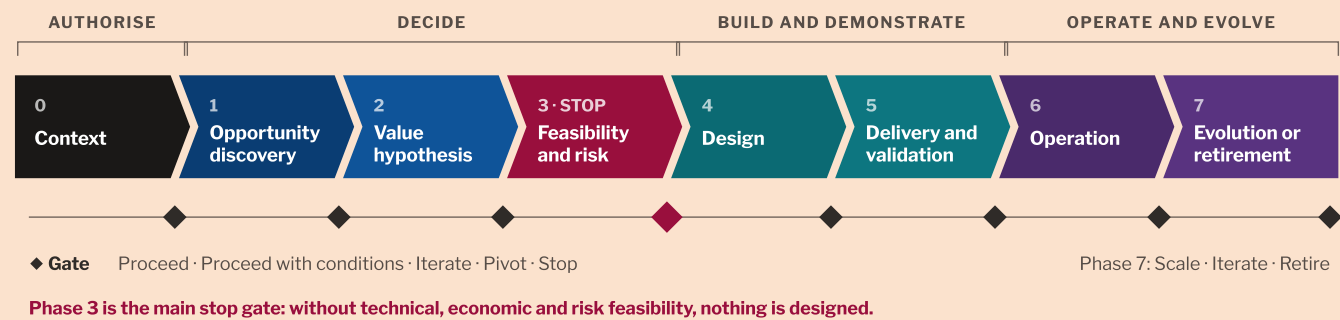
4.3 Initiative level · Lifecycle with decision gates

Each AI initiative goes through eight phases. **Phase 0** is enabling: without it, the initiative is not authorised. The **seven phases** that follow take the initiative from opportunity to demonstrated value, and the **G** in SEVEN-G expresses that governance is present in all of them.

Why it matters. The lifecycle prevents two expensive errors: moving to production without evidence and keeping value-poor initiatives alive by inertia. Decision gates introduce investment discipline and make timely stopping possible.

Initiative lifecycle

Eight phases with auditable decision gates and a real capacity to stop



Source: SEVEN-G · SEACHAD

Phase	Name	Objective	Main evidence
0	Context and constraints	Set strategic objectives and regulatory, ethical and budgetary constraints, and assign roles.	Initiative charter, context statement, role assignment record.
1	Opportunity discovery	Identify opportunities from the business and discard those that do not require AI.	Opportunity portfolio, screening notes, proposed sphere and ambition level.
2	Value hypothesis	Formulate a measurable and falsifiable hypothesis. If the hypothesis cannot fail, it is not valid.	Value hypothesis canvas, baseline metrics, attribution method.
3	Feasibility and risk	Assess technical, economic, data and risk feasibility. This is the main stop gate.	Feasibility assessment, regulatory classification, risk matrix and register, mitigation plan.
4	Solution design	Design the architecture, data and model lineage, human oversight, controls and reversibility.	Architecture record, data and model lineage, governance design, rollback plan.
5	Delivery and validation	Demonstrate value under real conditions. Theoretical results are not enough.	Delivery report, validation results, updated risk register.

Phase	Name	Objective	Main evidence
6	Operation and governance	Operate stably, watch for degradation, respond to incidents.	Operations manual, monitoring and alerting configuration, incident response plan.
7	Evolution or retirement	Scale, iterate or retire based on the evidence of value and risk.	Value realisation tracking, scaling or retirement decision record.

Decision gate rules

- Each *gate* is passed through **dual validation**: tangible results and verified documentation.
- Possible outcomes: **Proceed**, **Proceed with conditions**, **Iterate**, **Pivot** or **Stop**. In phase 7: **Scale**, **Iterate** or **Retire**.
- If any mandatory evidence is missing, the initiative does not proceed. Partial compliance only allows iterating or proceeding with explicit conditions, a deadline and an owner.
- No one approves their own work. Documentation produced after the fact in order to pass a *gate* invalidates the *gate*.
- A well-founded decision to stop is a valid outcome of the method: avoiding a bad investment also creates value.

Two application intensities

Version	When it applies	What changes
Lite	Low-risk initiatives, internal use, no decisions about people and no customer exposure, limited investment.	Grouped <i>gates</i> , simplified templates, decision by the sponsor with a record and verification by the AI Office.
Enterprise	Systems that are high-risk under regulation, direct exposure to customers or people, automated decisions, agents with the ability to act, regulated environments or significant investment.	All <i>gates</i> and evidence, independent audit, visibility for the AI Committee and, where appropriate, for the board.

4.4 Component B · Governance system

Why it matters. If decision, build and control duties are not separated, the framework loses credibility and operational and regulatory risk increases. A clear governance system speeds up sound decisions and reduces the cost of correcting errors.

Initiative roles, with segregation of duties:

Function	Role	Responsibility
Decides	AI Sponsor	Accountable for value and authorises the investment.
Builds	AI Product Owner	Accountable for the value hypothesis and adoption.
	AI Technical Owner	Accountable for the solution, the data and the models.
	AI Operations Owner	Accountable for stability, monitoring and incidents.
Controls	AI Risk Owner	Accountable for the assessment and monitoring of risk and compliance.
	AI Auditor	Verifies evidence at the <i>gates</i> and closes nonconformities. Independent of the team that builds.

Company bodies: the board (or its board committee) sets the thesis, the ambition and the risk appetite, and exercises oversight; an AI Committee manages the portfolio and resolves the highest-level *gates*; an AI Office or centre of excellence provides methodological support, maintains the inventory and consolidates measurement.

Risks: seven categories (strategic, technical, data, economic, legal and compliance, organisational and reputational), with probability and impact scales, response levels and escalation thresholds. These are complemented by risks specific to generative AI and agents, and by exposure to attacks that use AI.

Regulation: the framework maps each obligation to phases, roles and evidence. The main reference is the [EU AI Act](#), complemented by ISO/IEC 42001, the [NIST AI RMF framework](#), the [GDPR](#), [DORA](#), [NIS2](#) and whatever sector-specific regulation applies to each organisation.

4.5 Component C · Measurement system

Why it matters. What is not measured with common rules cannot be compared or audited. Measurement prevents declared savings from being mistaken for real savings and supports investment decisions based on verifiable economic impact.

Three instruments:

1. **Value per use case and per portfolio**, with explicit measurement rules (section 6).
2. **Maturity model** from 0 to 5, assessed by dimension and based on observable evidence: governance coverage, effectiveness of risk controls, stability in production, audited value realisation, people capability and data readiness.

3. **Transformation index**, which determines where the company's profile sits between efficiency and transformation (section 5).

4.6 Component D • Tools

Why it matters. Tools convert the method into day-to-day operation. Without templates, checklists and registers, the framework remains an intention; with them, decisions become traceable and repeatable across the company.

- **Templates** for each piece of evidence in each phase: initiative charter, value hypothesis canvas, *gate* decision record, risk matrix and register, operations manual, value realisation tracking, among others.
- **Checklists** for each *gate*, which turn the criteria into binary controls.
- **AI dashboard for the board:** inventory, validated versus declared value, cost, regulatory compliance, incidents, exposure to AI-enabled attacks, agent identity and permissions, adoption, agility and distribution by ambition level. It is generated from a single data file with a documented schema, with synchronised full and mobile versions.
- **Initiative register**, which manages the AI portfolio as a funnel: phase and status of each initiative, time spent in each phase, compliance with each decision gate, tags, value and stop reasons (document 03).
- **Board recommendations register**, with identifiers that are never reset, declared status, evidence provided and independent assessment.
- **Sector demonstrations** with fictitious data (banking, insurance, energy, manufacturing, retail, healthcare, telecommunications, logistics, pharmaceuticals, tourism and the public sector).

05

Transforming or just becoming more efficient: how SEVEN-G tells them apart

5.1 The principle

Efficiency and transformation are not distinguished by the technology used. A generative AI agent that drafts replies faster is optimisation; a classical statistical model that makes it possible to launch a

product with personalised pricing can be transformation. **What distinguishes one from the other is what changes in the business and where the value appears.**

SEVEN-G does not regard efficiency as a lesser outcome. Many companies need to start there and use it to fund their later bets. What the framework requires is that **the choice be conscious, measured and made by whoever is responsible for it.**

5.2 Initiative level · Classifying ambition with verifiable criteria

Each initiative is classified in phase 1, confirmed in phase 2 and reviewed in phase 7 against the actual evidence. The classification answers five questions:

#	Question	If the answer is yes, it points to...
1	Does it change the value proposition received by the customer or end user?	Transform
2	Is the process redesigned end to end, and not just a task within the process?	Augment or Transform
3	Do roles, organisational structure or who makes which decisions change?	Augment or Transform
4	Does it generate revenue, services or markets that did not exist before?	Transform
5	Could it be retired without affecting the business model, simply returning to the previous cost?	Optimise

If questions 1 to 4 are answered in the negative, the initiative is an **optimisation** initiative, regardless of how it has been presented. **Transformation** initiatives require an explicit decision by the board or senior management and are assessed using adapted *gate* criteria: the value hypothesis allows greater uncertainty, but requires intermediate learning milestones, investment limits per stage and stop criteria defined in advance.

5.3 Company level · Transformation index

The company's profile is determined by a set of observable signals, all of which can be measured with data from the board dashboard and the inventory:

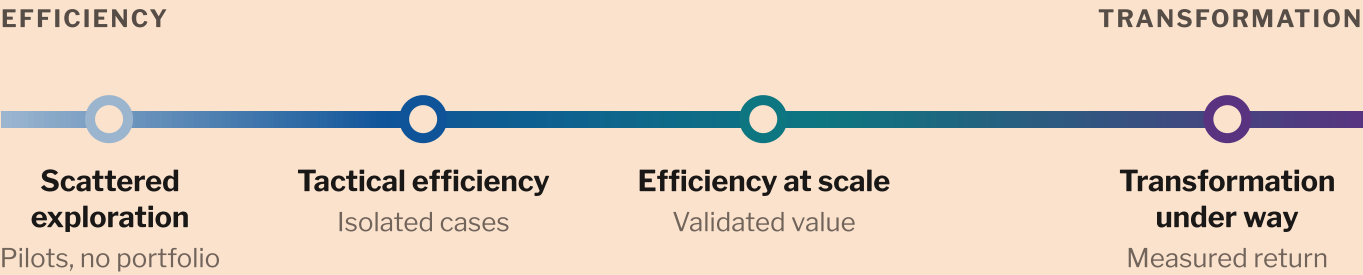
Signal	What is measured	Efficiency reading	Transformation reading
1. Investment mix	Distribution of cost and investment by ambition level.	Majority in Optimise.	Significant and sustained weight in Augment and Transform.

Signal	What is measured	Efficiency reading	Transformation reading
2. Value mix	Proportion of validated value coming from efficiencies versus return.	Almost everything is avoided cost.	Growing proportion of revenue, retention, price or new services.
3. Realisation	Released capacity that has become real savings or has been reassigned to new activities.	Released hours that are neither realised nor reassigned.	Capacity explicitly reassigned to higher-value activities.
4. Depth of change	Processes redesigned end to end versus automated tasks.	Automation of isolated tasks.	Redesigned processes with new decision points.
5. Operating model	Changes in roles, structure and the allocation of decisions between people and systems, with defined oversight.	No organisational change.	Redesigned roles and structures, and decisions delegated under control.
6. AI-enabled revenue	Percentage of revenue coming from products, services or channels that would not exist without AI.	Zero or marginal.	Significant and growing.
7. Move to production	Proportion of Augment and Transform initiatives that reach production, and how long they take.	Higher-ambition bets remain at pilot stage.	They reach production in timeframes comparable to the rest.
8. Board decision	Transformation decisions explicitly taken by the board and tracked in the register.	AI is treated as a technical or efficiency matter.	The board decides on, funds and oversees transformation bets.

With these signals, the company falls into one of five profiles:

Transformation index profiles

The company's position according to observable signals, not according to its discourse



Declared but unevidenced transformation

The discourse is one of transformation, but the signals show efficiency or exploration. It is the profile a board should be most interested in detecting.

Source: SEVEN-G · SEACHAD

Profile	Description
Scattered exploration	Pilots with no portfolio, no measurement and no decision on ambition.
Tactical efficiency	Optimisation use cases in production with partially measured value.
Efficiency at scale	A governed optimisation portfolio, with validated value and realised capacity. This is a solid outcome, but it is not transformation.
Transformation under way	Augmentation and transformation bets decided by the board, in production and with measured return.
Declared but unevidenced transformation	The narrative is one of transformation, but the signals show efficiency or exploration. This is the profile a board is most interested in detecting.

The numerical thresholds for each signal and the weighting of the index will be calibrated in the dedicated transformation index document, based on the practical application of the framework.

Value measurement rules

These rules are the core of the measurement system and apply to all use cases, in all phases and in all reports:

1. **Every amount has a formula** (units × unit value) and is **incremental** against a baseline or a control group.
2. **Every amount has a status**: validated, declared or estimated. Reports to the board always show the proportion of validated value.
3. **Released capacity is not counted** as savings until it is realised (lower actual cost) or explicitly reassigned. It is reported separately.
4. **A potential without its additional investment, its hypothesis and its timeframe is not a data point.**
5. **Each euro is attributed to a single use case.** When several use cases share an outcome, the allocation is declared.
6. **Efficiencies, return and recurring cost are kept separate.** Annual net value is the sum of efficiencies and return minus recurring cost.
7. **Every magnitude is translated into money.** Improvements in retention, quality or satisfaction are converted into their economic effect, or it is stated that they could not be quantified.
8. **"No data" is not zero.** Missing data is shown as missing and is never estimated without saying so.
9. **Prioritisation uses additional net value per additional euro invested**, not aggregate indicators that hide use cases with negative value.
10. **Each use case explains what it is and what it is used for**, in language that non-specialists can understand.

07

Who it is for

Audience	How it helps them
Board of directors and committees	Oversee AI in business language, know the company's real profile between efficiency and transformation, demand evidence and follow up on their recommendations.
Senior management	Set the thesis and the ambition, manage the portfolio, balance speed and control, and be accountable with defensible figures.
AI, data and technology leaders	Have a common lifecycle, templates and criteria that reduce debate and speed up decisions.
Risk, compliance, data protection and internal audit	Rely on controls, evidence and audit criteria built in by design.
Business areas	Turn their needs into value hypotheses that can be approved, measured and scaled.

SEVEN-G is **sector- and technology-agnostic**, and scalable: the Lite version is suitable for mid-sized organisations and the Enterprise version for regulated groups.

08

Framework principles

1. **Value before technology.** Every initiative is linked to a measurable business outcome.
 2. **Governance is not optional.** It is designed in from the start and makes it possible to move faster with control.
 3. **Production is the only truth.** Value is demonstrated under real conditions.
 4. **Reversibility.** Every solution can be stopped, rolled back or retired.
 5. **Risk is systemic.** It is managed at portfolio level, not only case by case.
 6. **Evolve or retire.** No initiative remains in the portfolio without evidence to justify it.
 7. **Segregation of duties.** Whoever builds does not control, and no one approves their own work.
 8. **Evidence, not declaration.** If it is not documented and verified, it is not considered done.
 9. **A conscious decision on ambition.** Efficiency and transformation are chosen, measured and decided separately.
 10. **People at the centre of change.** AI is also assessed by what it does to people's work, capabilities and responsibilities.
-

09

What a company that adopts SEVEN-G gains

- A **single view of its AI**: what it has, what it costs, what it contributes with evidence, what risks it takes on and who is accountable for each.
- An **honest diagnosis** of where it stands between efficiency and transformation.
- A **decision-making system** that makes it possible to start, accelerate, set conditions for, pivot and stop initiatives using known criteria.
- **Demonstrable regulatory compliance**, with evidence linked to each obligation.
- A **board able to oversee AI** with information that is understandable, comparable over time and verifiable.
- A **common language** across business, technology, risk and the board.

Document library

SEVEN-G version 0.1 is operational. Every document, template and tool in this table is available in HTML and PDF, in Spanish and English, and is listed in the library index. Each page shows its downloads and related tools below the cover.

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from P01 to P31, one for each piece of mandatory
evidence in the lifecycle, linked from the library

index. | | I • Tools | Initiative register T01 (with system inventory, *gate* manager, intensity determination and ambition classification) and connector T17, which feeds the board dashboard and the recommendations register with the register's data. | | J • Framework adoption | 90 • Implementation guide • 91 • Guide for consultants and support models • 92 • Application cases • 93 • Licence, use by third parties and citation |

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Version control

Version	Date	Changes
0.1	16-09-2026	First version. Unifies the existing materials (foundational methodology, <i>gate</i> criteria, spheres framework, framework templates and board dashboard measurement rules) into a common model, introduces the corporate cycle and the transformation index, and sets the content licence.

External sources cited

Links to the official or primary source, checked before publication. Always verify the version in force on the date of use.

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